

IBA 2026 ANNUAL CONFERENCE

CONFERENCE AGENDA

October 18, 2026

The Inn at Villanova University

601 County Line Road, Radnor, PA 19087



TIME	BALLROOM	TRACK 1 ROOM 114	TRACK 2 ROOM 119	TRACK 3 ROOM 120
8:00-8:30 AM	Registration & Welcome			
8:30-9:50 AM	Morning Keynote Speeches			
9:50-10:00 AM	Diamond Sponsor Spotlight opAlda & DIP			
10:00-10:30 AM	Group Photo & Coffee Break			
10:30 AM-12:00 PM		AI & RWE	Cardiovascular & Metabolic Disease	Startup & BD
12:00-1:00 PM	Awards & Lunch Buffet			
1:00-2:30 PM		Oncology	Neuroscience	NAM & Organoid
2:30-3:00 PM	Coffee Break in Room 115 (Sponsor Exhibit, 10 AM-5 PM)			
3:00-4:30 PM		Statistics & Regulatory	CMC Challenges	Career Development
4:30-5:00 PM	Networking			
5:00-5:30 PM	Dinner Check-in			
5:30-6:30 PM	Evening Keynote Speeches			
6:30-8:30 PM	Live Music & Dinner Buffet			

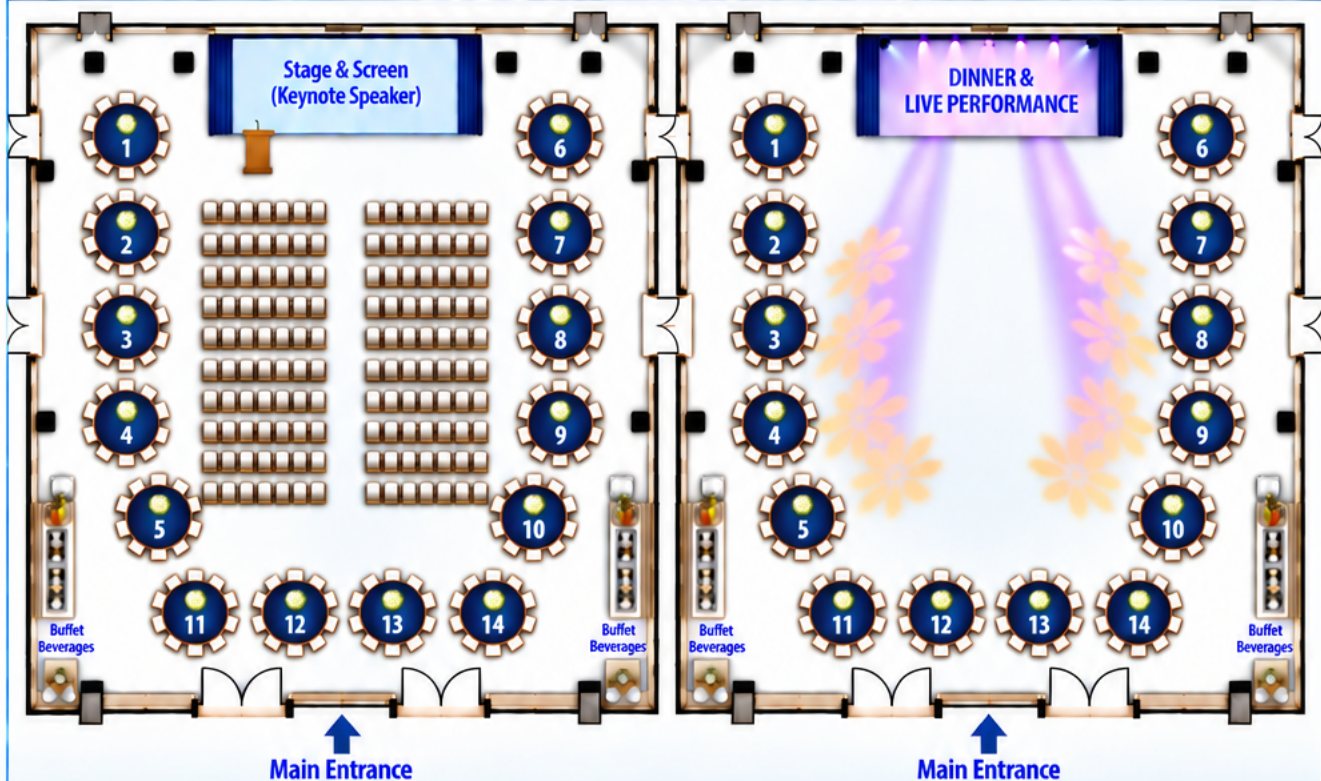


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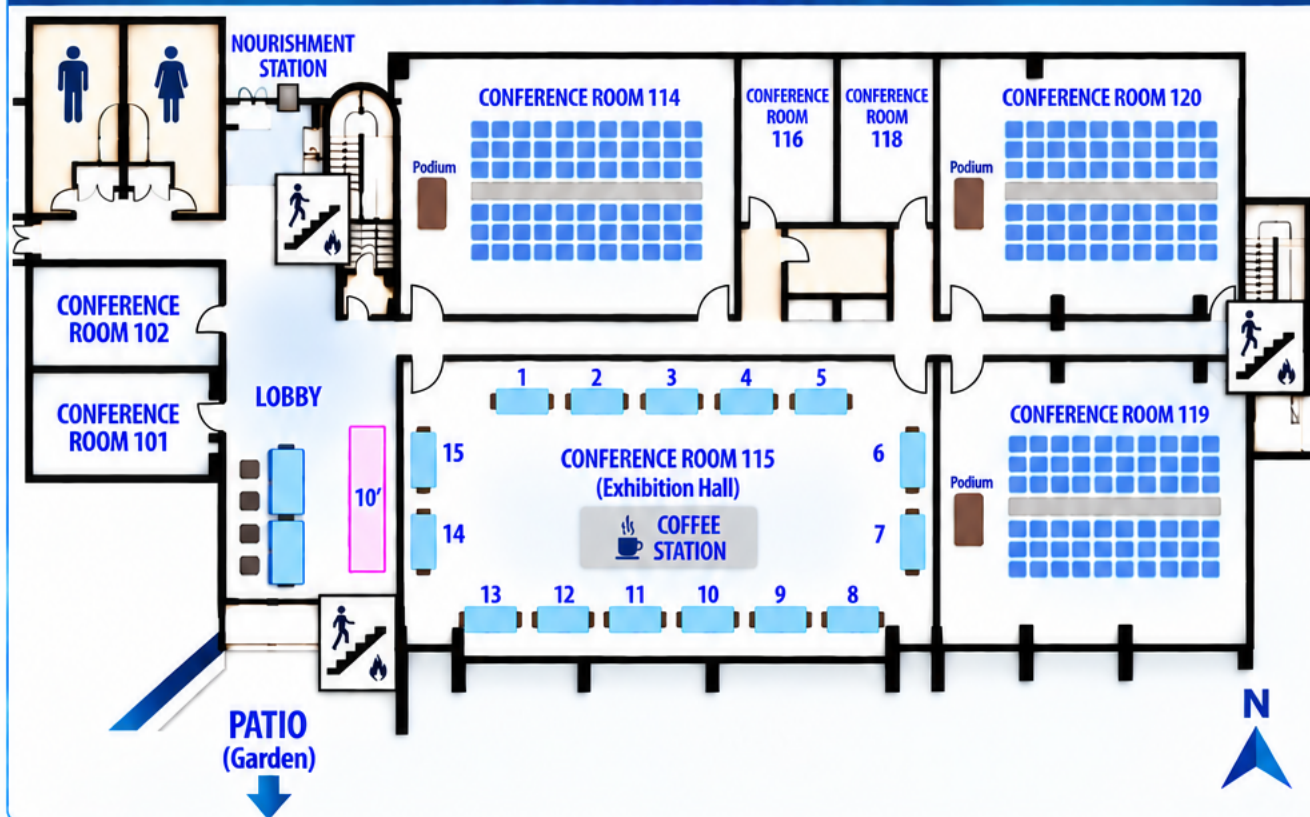
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BALLROOM LAYOUT



MEETING ROOMS



IBA 2026 ANNUAL CONFERENCE

Morning Keynote Session

Ballroom • 8:30–10:00 AM



This keynote session brings together distinguished industry leaders to share perspectives on advancing innovative medicines from scientific breakthrough to patient impact. The talks will highlight strategies for accelerating genetic medicines, translating innovation toward commercialization, and enabling oral delivery of complex therapeutics.

KEYNOTE SPEAKERS



Peter Marks, MD, PhD

Senior Vice President for Molecule Development
& Head of Infectious Disease, Eli Lilly

*Accelerating the Development of
Genetic Medicines*

8:35–9:00 AM



Anthony Vaganos, MBA

Vice President, GSK

*Beginning with the End in Mind:
Innovation for Commercialization*

9:00–9:25 AM



Filippas Kesisoglou, PhD

Scientific Associate Vice President,
Merck & Co.

*Enabling Oral Delivery of a
Macrocyclic Peptide*

9:25–9:50 AM

SESSION CHAIRS



Dongmei Wang, PhD

President, IBA
Executive Vice President,
Frontage Laboratories



Ling Yang, PhD

Board Chair, IBA
Associate Professor,
Lewis Katz School of Medicine
at Temple University

October 18, 2026 • 8:30–10:00 AM

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Evening Keynote Session

Ballroom • 5:30–6:30 PM



An inspiring evening keynote program bringing together distinguished leaders in biopharmaceutical innovation and neuroscience, with perspectives spanning the translation of science into medicines and the use of brain organoids to advance functional genetics discovery.

KEYNOTE SPEAKERS



Hugh Davis, PhD

President and COO
Aclaris Therapeutics

*Innovation of Antibody-based Therapeutics
with a Focus on Atopic Disease*

5:35–6:00 PM



Guoli Ming, MD, PhD

Member, National Academy of Medicine
Professor of Neuroscience, Perelman School of Medicine
University of Pennsylvania

*Brain Organoids as Tools for Functional
Genetics Discovery*

6:05–6:30 PM

SESSION CHAIRS



Dongmei Wang, PhD

President, IBA
Executive Vice President,
Frontage Laboratories



Ling Yang, PhD

Board Chair, IBA
Associate Professor,
Lewis Katz School of Medicine
at Temple University

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IBA 2026 ANNUAL CONFERENCE

AI & RWE Session

October 18, 2026 • 10:30 AM-12:00 PM



AI and real-world evidence are increasingly transforming how biomedical data are integrated, interpreted, and translated into drug development decisions. This session brings together leaders from academia and industry to explore multimodal AI integrating brain imaging, genomics, and clinical data in Alzheimer's disease; AI-assisted external control arms in oncology; and the evolution from paperless to autonomous bioanalysis. The session will conclude with an interactive panel discussion on opportunities, validation, and practical implementation of AI and RWE across the drug development lifecycle.

FEATURED SPEAKERS



Li Shen, PhD

Fellow of AIMBE, ACMI & AMIA | Professor of Informatics & Interim Director, Division of Informatics | Perelman School of Medicine, University of Pennsylvania

Multimodal AI for Drug Discovery: Integrating Brain Imaging, Genomics, & Clinical Data in Alzheimer's Disease

10:30-10:50 AM



Gerald L. "Gerry" Klein, MD

Founder & Principal, MedSurgPI, LLC | Adjunct Professor of Pharmacology | The Brody School of Medicine, East Carolina University

AI-Assisted External Control Arms in Oncology

10:50-11:10 AM



John Lin, PhD

Co-CEO, Frontage Laboratories, Inc.

From Paperless to Autonomous Bioanalysis: Bridging Dry-Lab Speed, Wet-Lab Validation, and the Dark Lab Future

11:10-11:30 AM



Tianhao Wu, PhD

Founder & CHO, opAlda, Inc.

Panel Discussion

11:30 AM-12:00 PM



Kevin He, MBA

Director of Business Development | Deep Intelligent Pharma

Panel Discussion

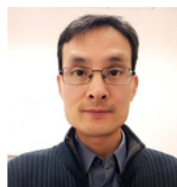
11:30 AM-12:00 PM

SESSION CHAIRS



Yunyun (Jade) Zhou, PhD

Founder, AiMi Health
Adjunct Professor, Brown University



Weifeng Xu, PhD

Senior Scientific Director
Regulated Bioanalytics, Merck & Co., Inc.

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Conference & Registration

IBA 2026 ANNUAL CONFERENCE

Cardiovascular & Metabolic Disease Session

October 18, 2026 • 10:30 AM–12:00 PM



This session brings together industry leaders and academic pioneers at the forefront of cardiovascular and metabolic medicine. Topics span next-generation clinical development for MASH, evolving incretin therapies, in vivo corrective gene editing, and clinical assay optimization, followed by an interactive panel on unmet clinical needs and future therapeutic directions.

FEATURED SPEAKERS



Anlong Li, MD, PhD

Executive Director
Madrigal Pharmaceuticals

MASH: The Next Chapter – From First Approvals to the Next Generation of Clinical Development

10:30-10:45 AM



Ajay Rao, MD

Professor & Chief, Adult Endocrinology, Diabetes and Metabolism, Temple University

Incretin Therapies for Cardiometabolic Disease in the Clinic – Past, Present, Future

10:45-11:00 AM



Xiao Wang, PhD

Assistant Professor
University of Pennsylvania

Therapeutic Gene Editing for Metabolic Diseases: Building a Platform for In Vivo Corrective Editing

11:00-11:15 AM



Xinyuan Li, PhD

Senior Principal Scientist
Johnson & Johnson Innovative Medicine

Impact of Serum Omission on Clinical ELISpot Assays

11:15-11:30 AM



Filippas Kesiosoglou, PhD

Scientific Associate Vice President
Merck & Co.

Panel Discussion & Q&A: Unmet Clinical Needs and Future Directions

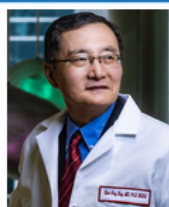
11:30 AM-12:00 PM

SESSION CHAIRS



Ling Yang, PhD

Board Chair, IBA
Associate Professor, Lewis Katz School of Medicine at Temple University



Xiaofeng Yang, MD, PhD, FAHA

Professor & Associate Director, Lemole Center for Integrated Lymphatics and Vascular Research, Lewis Katz School of Medicine at Temple University

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Conference & Registration

IBA 2026 ANNUAL CONFERENCE

Startup & BD Session

October 18, 2026 • 10:30 AM-12:00 PM



Turning scientific innovation into successful biopharmaceutical ventures requires more than great science—it requires capital, strategic decision-making, and the ability to navigate a rapidly changing development landscape. This session brings together leaders from biotechnology, pharma, investment, and business development to discuss the evolving environment for science and research funding, the impact of AI, and quantitative approaches to evaluating early oncology assets. The session will conclude with an interactive panel discussion on building, funding, partnering, and advancing innovative biotech companies.

FEATURED SPEAKERS



Louis P. Kassa III, MPA
CEO, Pennsylvania Biotechnology Center (PABC), Baruch S. Blumberg Institute & Hepatitis B Foundation

On the State of the Union with Science, Funding, and Research: AI Impact

10:30-10:45 AM



Cong Chen, PhD
Scientific AVP, Merck

Evaluating Early Oncology Assets — A Quantitative Lens for BD Decisions

10:45-11:00 AM



Yuhang Zhao, PhD, MBA
Founder & Principal, Horton Inc.; ex-VP, Bayer

Panel Discussion

11:00 AM-12:00 PM



Anthony Vaganos, MS, MBA
VP, GSK

Panel Discussion

11:00 AM-12:00 PM



Chao Liu, PhD
Co-Founder & CEO, Stealth Drug Development Company

Panel Discussion

11:00 AM-12:00 PM



Rui Che
Senior Managing Director, KPMG

Panel Discussion

11:00 AM-12:00 PM

SESSION CHAIRS



Vivian (Mingyue) Li, PhD, MBA

Early Stage Investor, K2VC



Qing Liang, PhD

CEO, Neulink Pharmaceuticals

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Oncology Innovation Session



From Right Target to Right Patient — Ultimately, Right Market

October 18, 2026 • 1:00–2:30 PM

Oncology innovation increasingly depends on connecting the full development journey—from selecting the right target and therapeutic modality to optimizing exposure, identifying the right patients, and ultimately reaching the right market. This session brings together experts across discovery, translational science, ADME/PK/PD, statistics, clinical development, and commercialization to explore how great science can be translated into medicines that benefit patients.

FEATURED SPEAKERS



Raymond Evers, PhD
Senior Director, J&J

*Transporters and Emerging
Therapeutic Modalities*

1:00–1:15 PM



Shouye Wang, PhD
Senior Director, WuXi XDC

*Developing Next-Generation
ADCs to Overcome Drug
Resistance in Cancer*

1:15–1:30 PM



Chao Han, PhD

Senior Consultant
PharmTracks Consulting LLC

*Engineering Right Molecule for
Right Target and Testing
Pharmacology in Clinical Trials*

1:30–1:45 PM

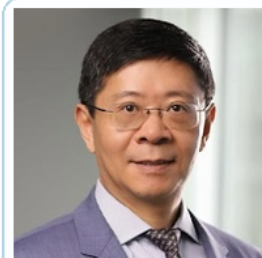


Huaxin Gao, PhD

Senior Director, BeOne
Medicines

Panel Discussion

1:45–2:30 PM



Cong Chen, PhD

AVP, Merck

Panel Discussion

1:45–2:30 PM

SESSION CHAIRS



Bonnie Wu, PhD

Associate Director, J&J



Daniel (Yue) Zhu, MD, PhD

Senior Director, BioNTech



Yi Zhu, MD, MBA

VP, Global Clinical Development
Ionova Life Science
IBA President-Elect

October 18, 2026 • 1:00–2:30 PM

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Organoid technologies and New Approach Methodologies (NAMs) are transforming biomedical research and drug development. This session brings together experts from academia and industry to highlight advances in cardiac and brain organoids, patient-derived tumor models, preclinical research platforms, and emerging NAMs.

FEATURED SPEAKERS

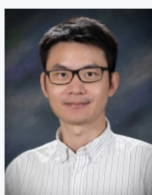


Bin Jiang, PhD

Research Director
Eureka Biotech Inc.

*Label-Free Optical Mapping
for Spiral Wave
Visualization in 3D Cardiac
Organoids*

1:00-1:15 PM



Ranjie Xu, PhD

Assistant Professor
Purdue University

*Vascularized neuroimmune
organoids for Alzheimer's
modeling and drug discovery*

1:15-1:30 PM



Xin Wang, PhD

Postdoctoral Fellow
Perelman School of Medicine
University of Pennsylvania

*A Standardized Patient-
derived Glioblastoma
Organoid Platform for
Evaluating Radiotherapy
Efficacy and Overcoming
Resistance*

1:30-1:45 PM

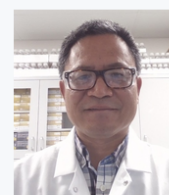


Tingting Zhou, PhD

Founder & CEO
HepaBio

*Organoid Platform for
Preclinical Research*

1:45-2:00 PM



Yongzhong Zhao, MD, PhD

Senior Principal Scientist
Frontage Laboratories, Inc.

*Future Direction and
Current Development of NAMs
and Organoid Research*

2:00-2:15 PM

SESSION CHAIRS



Jian Huang, MD, PhD

Professor & Interim Chief Scientific Officer
Coriell Institute for Medical Research



Jin Liu, PhD, PMP

Founder & CEO, GenCell LLC

PANEL DISCUSSION 2:15-2:30 PM

Opportunities and future directions in NAMs and organoid research

October 18, 2026 • 1:00-2:30 PM

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From Evidence to Decisions: The Evolving Role of Statistics in Drug Development



October 18, 2026 • 3:00–4:30 PM

Statistics in drug development has evolved far beyond trial design and data analysis. This session explores how statistical evidence can support decision-making across clinical development, oncology dose optimization, trusted AI, and licensing. Three short talks will be followed by a panel discussion on how teams evaluate uncertainty, identify critical risks, and turn emerging evidence into decision-ready insights.

FEATURED SPEAKERS



Fei Chen, PhD

Senior Director of Biostatistics,
Johnson & Johnson Innovative
Medicine

*Efficiency+: Expanding the Role of
Statistics Beyond Trial Design and
Analysis*

3:00–3:15 PM



Jason Liao, PhD

Associate Vice President, Incyte
Corporation

*Misconceptions and Pitfalls in
Oncology Dose Optimization*

3:15–3:30 PM



Jian Chen, MBA, MS

Founder, President & CEO
EDETEK

*From Digital Protocols to Statistical
Decision-Making: A Neuro-Symbolic
Strategy for Trusted AI in Regulated
Clinical Development*

3:30–3:45 PM



Steven Sun, PhD

Therapeutic Area Head of
Statistical Decision Sciences –
Cardiopulmonary, Johnson &
Johnson Innovative Medicine

Panel Discussion

3:45–4:30 PM



Ming Zhou, PhD

Senior Director of Biostatistics,
Bristol Myers Squibb

Panel Discussion

3:45–4:30 PM

SESSION CHAIRS



Qi Xia, PhD

Director, Geron
Adjunct Professor,
Loyola University Maryland



Yanfei Gao

Founder & CEO
SKY Pharmaceutical Development

October 18, 2026 • 3:00–4:30 PM

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CMC Challenges Session

October 18, 2026 • 3:00-4:30 PM



CMC development is where scientific innovation must be translated into a robust, scalable, and regulatory-ready product. This session brings together experienced CMC leaders to explore critical challenges across drug substance, drug product, analytical development, and regulatory strategy—from the art of drug substance development and evolving extractables and leachables requirements to leveraging 505(b)(2) precedents to inform development decisions. The session will conclude with an interactive panel discussion on practical CMC challenges and strategies across the drug development lifecycle.

FEATURED SPEAKERS



Hui-Yin (Harry) Li, Ph.D.

Founder & CEO, Wilmington PharmaTech

The Art of Drug Substance Development

3:00-3:20 PM



Madhu Pudipeddi, Ph.D.

Senior Vice President, Technical Operations | Prelude Therapeutics

Unlocking 505(b)(2) Precedents: A Purpose-Built Tool for Curated Drug Monographs

3:20-3:40 PM



Kevin Li, Ph.D.

Senior Director of CMC Analytical | Frontage Laboratories Inc.

Navigating Extractables and Leachables: Meeting Today's Standards

3:40-4:00 PM



Hong Lin, Ph.D.

Senior Vice President, Drug Discovery | Quanta Therapeutics

Panel Discussion

4:00-4:30 PM



Wei Cao, Ph.D., MBA

Head of Analytical Development and Quality Control at ProBio

Panel Discussion

4:00-4:30 PM

SESSION CHAIRS



Huan Cai, Ph.D.

CMC Program Lead, Syncromune



Selina Chen, Ph.D., MBA

Analytical CMC & QC Professional
National Resilience



Dongmei Wang, Ph.D.

Executive Vice President
Frontage Laboratories, Inc.
President, IBA

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